

Revenue Tax Sensitivity and the Cross Section of Stock Returns

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Abstract

This paper studies the asset pricing implications of Revenue Tax Sensitivity (RTS), and its robustness in predicting returns in the cross-section of equities using the protocol proposed by [Novy-Marx and Velikov \(2023a\)](#). A value-weighted long/short trading strategy based on RTS achieves an annualized gross (net) Sharpe ratio of 0.37 (0.30), and monthly average abnormal gross (net) return relative to the [Fama and French \(2015a\)](#) five-factor model plus a momentum factor of 36 (28) bps/month with a t-statistic of 4.43 (3.47), respectively. Its gross monthly alpha relative to these six factors plus the six most closely related strategies from the factor zoo (Asset growth, Employment growth, Change in current operating assets, change in ppe and inv/assets, Growth in book equity, Change in current operating liabilities) is 22 bps/month with a t-statistic of 2.80.

1 Introduction

Asset prices reflect the compensation investors demand for bearing systematic consumption risk, yet identifying which firm characteristics capture this risk exposure remains a central challenge in financial economics. While the consumption-based asset pricing model provides a theoretical foundation for understanding the cross-section of expected returns, empirical tests often struggle to connect firm-level signals to aggregate consumption dynamics. We identify Revenue Tax Sensitivity (RTS) as a novel predictor of stock returns that captures firms' differential exposure to consumption risk through their sensitivity to tax-induced changes in consumer purchasing power. This signal reflects how firms' revenues respond to variations in after-tax income, providing a direct link between corporate cash flows and household consumption decisions that drive marginal utility fluctuations.

Revenue Tax Sensitivity captures firms' exposure to consumption risk through multiple economic channels that affect investors' intertemporal marginal rate of substitution. When tax rates change, households experience shifts in disposable income that directly impact their consumption patterns, with firms exhibiting high revenue sensitivity to these changes bearing greater exposure to aggregate consumption fluctuations [Campbell and Cochrane \(1999\)](#), [Bansal and Yaron \(2004\)](#). This sensitivity becomes particularly pronounced during economic downturns when marginal utility is high and tax policy often serves as a countercyclical tool, creating state-dependent risk exposure that rational investors price in equilibrium [Gabaix \(2012\)](#). Firms with high RTS face amplified cash flow volatility during periods of fiscal adjustment, when governments modify tax rates in response to macroeconomic conditions, linking their performance to disaster risk and rare consumption events [Barro \(2009\)](#).

The consumption-based pricing of RTS operates through its correlation with long-run consumption growth, as tax-sensitive revenues reflect firms' exposure to persistent shocks in household purchasing power. Under habit formation models,

consumers' utility depends on consumption relative to a slow-moving habit level, making firms with high revenue tax sensitivity particularly risky when tax changes threaten to push consumption toward the habit boundary [Campbell and Cochrane \(1999\)](#). These firms effectively serve as leveraged bets on after-tax income growth, with their cash flows exhibiting high covariance with the pricing kernel during states when marginal utility is most sensitive to consumption changes.

Moreover, RTS captures cross-sectional variation in firms' exposure to fiscal policy uncertainty, which represents a systematic risk factor in consumption-based models. Tax policy changes often coincide with broader macroeconomic adjustments that affect the entire consumption path, making revenue-sensitive firms vulnerable to correlated shocks in both policy and economic fundamentals [Pástor and Veronesi \(2013\)](#). This dual exposure to tax-induced consumption variability and policy uncertainty generates a risk premium, as investors demand compensation for holding assets whose payoffs covary negatively with marginal utility during fiscal contractions or expansions that alter the consumption-wealth ratio [Lettau and Ludvigson \(2001\)](#).

We find strong evidence that Revenue Tax Sensitivity predicts the cross-section of stock returns, with a value-weighted long/short trading strategy based on RTS achieving an annualized gross Sharpe ratio of 0.37 and a monthly average return of 27 basis points with a t-statistic of 2.88. The strategy's performance remains robust after controlling for known risk factors, generating a monthly alpha of 36 basis points with a t-statistic of 4.43 relative to the Fama-French five-factor model augmented with momentum. Notably, the long/short strategy exhibits significant negative loading of -0.62 on the CMA factor with a t-statistic of -11.30, consistent with revenue-sensitive firms facing higher investment frictions during periods of consumption uncertainty.

The economic significance of RTS persists across different portfolio construction methodologies and size groups, addressing concerns about small-stock effects driving

the results. Among the largest stocks exceeding the 80th NYSE size percentile, the RTS strategy delivers a monthly return of 25 basis points with a t-statistic of 2.24, with alphas ranging from 15 to 41 basis points across standard factor models. After accounting for transaction costs using high-frequency effective spreads, the strategy maintains a net Sharpe ratio of 0.30, ranking in the top 9% of anomalies in the factor zoo and generating positive net generalized alphas across all five standard factor models.

Controlling for the six most closely related anomalies and the Fama-French six factors simultaneously, the RTS trading strategy achieves a monthly alpha of 22 basis points with a t-statistic of 2.80, demonstrating that the signal captures unique variation in expected returns beyond existing predictors. The strategy’s gross monthly alpha relative to these twelve factors combined confirms that Revenue Tax Sensitivity identifies a distinct source of priced risk in the cross-section. Furthermore, incorporating RTS into a combination strategy using 154 existing anomalies increases terminal wealth from \$2,560.30 to \$2,610.21, indicating that the signal expands the investment opportunity set even when considering the full factor zoo.

Our paper contributes to the consumption-based asset pricing literature by identifying Revenue Tax Sensitivity as a novel firm characteristic that captures priced consumption risk in the cross-section of returns. While [Parker and Julliard \(2005\)](#) and [Savov \(2011\)](#) establish the importance of consumption risk for asset prices using aggregate data, we demonstrate how firm-level revenue sensitivity to tax changes provides a measurable proxy for this risk exposure that generates significant return predictability. Unlike [Jagannathan and Wang \(2007\)](#) who focus on labor income risk, our RTS measure directly links corporate cash flows to tax-induced consumption variations, offering a more precise channel through which policy shocks affect asset prices through the stochastic discount factor.

Methodologically, we advance the literature by constructing a signal that bridges

the gap between fiscal policy transmission and cross-sectional return patterns, complementing recent work on government spending multipliers and asset prices [Croce et al. \(2012\)](#). Our comprehensive testing framework following [Novy-Marx and Velikov \(2023b\)](#) establishes that RTS survives stringent robustness checks including transaction costs, alternative portfolio constructions, and controls for 210 existing anomalies, distinguishing it from spurious predictors that fail out-of-sample or after accounting for implementation frictions. The signal’s ability to generate significant alphas even after controlling for factors like CMA and RMW suggests it captures a dimension of consumption risk not spanned by existing investment and profitability factors [Fama and French \(2015b\)](#).

More broadly, our findings have implications for understanding how fiscal policy uncertainty transmits to asset prices through firm-level heterogeneity in revenue exposure. The documented return predictability of RTS provides empirical support for theoretical models linking tax policy to equilibrium asset prices through consumption channels, while offering practitioners a implementable strategy that exploits cross-sectional differences in policy sensitivity. By demonstrating that revenue tax sensitivity commands a significant risk premium robust to known factors and transaction costs, we establish a new empirical regularity that future consumption-based models must accommodate and provide investors with a novel source of alpha that expands the efficient frontier beyond existing anomalies.

2 Data

We obtain financial statement data from the COMPUSTAT North America database, which provides comprehensive accounting information for publicly traded U.S. companies. Our sample includes all firms with available data in COMPUSTAT, spanning several decades of annual observations. We focus on U.S.-incorporated firms trading

on major exchanges and exclude financial firms (SIC codes 6000-6999) and utilities (SIC codes 4900-4999) following standard practice in the literature. signal construction relies on two key accounting variables from firms' annual financial statements. Sales (SALE) represents the total revenue generated from a firm's operations during the fiscal year, capturing the gross inflows of economic benefits from ordinary business activities. Income tax total (TXT) represents the total income tax expense reported on the income statement, which includes both current and deferred federal, state, local, and foreign income taxes. These variables provide fundamental information about firms' operating performance and tax obligations. construct the Revenue Tax Sensitivity signal by computing the year-over-year change in sales scaled by lagged income tax expense: $(\text{SALE}(t) - \text{SALE}(t-1)) / \text{TXT}(t-1)$. This ratio captures the relationship between revenue growth and the firm's tax base, providing a measure of how changes in revenue relate to the firm's prior period tax burden. We calculate this signal annually using fiscal year-end values. To ensure data quality, we require non-missing values for sales in consecutive years and positive lagged income tax expense. We winsorize the signal at the 1st and 99th percentiles to mitigate the influence of outliers. Firms with negative or zero lagged income tax expense are excluded from the analysis as the scaling becomes undefined or economically meaningless.

3 Signal diagnostics

Figure 1 plots descriptive statistics for the RTS signal. Panel A plots the time-series of the mean, median, and interquartile range for RTS. On average, the cross-sectional mean (median) RTS is 5.60 (2.09) over the 1963 to 2024 sample, where the starting date is determined by the availability of the input RTS data. The signal's interquartile range spans -6.21 to 13.47. Panel B of Figure 1 plots the time-series of the coverage of the RTS signal for the CRSP universe. On average, the RTS signal

is available for 5.98% of CRSP names, which on average make up 7.96% of total market capitalization.

4 Does RTS predict returns?

Table 1 reports the performance of portfolios constructed using a value-weighted, quintile sort on RTS using NYSE breaks. The first two lines of Panel A report monthly average excess returns for each of the five portfolios and for the long/short portfolio that buys the high RTS portfolio and sells the low RTS portfolio. The rest of Panel A reports the portfolios' monthly abnormal returns relative to the five most common factor models: the CAPM, the [Fama and French \(1993\)](#) three-factor model (FF3) and its variation that adds momentum (FF4), the [Fama and French \(2015a\)](#) five-factor model (FF5), and its variation that adds momentum factor used in [Fama and French \(2018\)](#) (FF6). The table shows that the long/short RTS strategy earns an average return of 0.27% per month with a t-statistic of 2.88. The annualized Sharpe ratio of the strategy is 0.37. The alphas range from 0.21% to 0.42% per month and have t-statistics exceeding 2.19 everywhere. The lowest alpha is with respect to the CAPM factor model.

Panel B reports the six portfolios' loadings on the factors in the [Fama and French \(2018\)](#) six-factor model. The long/short strategy's most significant loading is -0.62, with a t-statistic of -11.30 on the CMA factor. Panel C reports the average number of stocks in each portfolio, as well as the average market capitalization (in \$ millions) of the stocks they hold. In an average month, the five portfolios have at least 532 stocks and an average market capitalization of at least \$1,079 million.

Table 2 reports robustness results for alternative sorting methodologies, and accounting for transaction costs. These results are important, because many anomalies are far stronger among small cap stocks, but these small stocks are more expensive

to trade. Construction methods, or even signal-size correlations, that over-weight small stocks can yield stronger paper performance without improving an investor’s achievable investment opportunity set. Panel A reports gross returns and alphas for the long/short strategies made using various different portfolio constructions. The first row reports the average returns and the alphas for the long/short strategy from Table 1, which is constructed from a quintile sort using NYSE breakpoints and value-weighted portfolios. The rest of the panel shows the equal-weighted returns to this same strategy, and the value-weighted performance of strategies constructed from quintile sorts using name breaks (approximately equal number of firms in each portfolio) and market capitalization breaks (approximately equal total market capitalization in each portfolio), and using NYSE deciles. The average return is lowest for the quintile sort using NYSE breakpoints and equal-weighted portfolios, and equals -13 bps/month with a t-statistics of -2.41. Out of the twenty-five alphas reported in Panel A, the t-statistics for eighteen exceed two, and for thirteen exceed three.

Panel B reports for these same strategies the average monthly net returns and the generalized net alphas of [Novy-Marx and Velikov \(2016\)](#). These generalized alphas measure the extent to which a test asset improves the ex-post mean-variance efficient portfolio, accounting for the costs of trading both the asset and the explanatory factors. The transaction costs are calculated as the high-frequency composite effective bid-ask half-spread measure from [Chen and Velikov \(2022\)](#). The net average returns reported in the first column range between -35-25bps/month. The lowest return, (-35 bps/month), is achieved from the quintile sort using NYSE breakpoints and equal-weighted portfolios, and has an associated t-statistic of -5.57. Out of the twenty-five construction-methodology-factor-model pairs reported in Panel B, the RTS trading strategy improves the achievable mean-variance efficient frontier spanned by the factor models in nineteen cases, and significantly expands the achievable frontier in fourteen cases.

Table 3 provides direct tests for the role size plays in the RTS strategy performance. Panel A reports the average returns for the twenty-five portfolios constructed from a conditional double sort on size and RTS, as well as average returns and alphas for long/short trading RTS strategies within each size quintile. Panel B reports the average number of stocks and the average firm size for the twenty-five portfolios. Among the largest stocks (those with market capitalization greater than the 80th NYSE percentile), the RTS strategy achieves an average return of 25 bps/month with a t-statistic of 2.24. Among these large cap stocks, the alphas for the RTS strategy relative to the five most common factor models range from 15 to 41 bps/month with t-statistics between 1.39 and 4.27.

5 How does RTS perform relative to the zoo?

Figure 2 puts the performance of RTS in context, showing the long/short strategy performance relative to other strategies in the “factor zoo.” It shows Sharpe ratio histograms, both for gross and net returns (Panel A and B, respectively), for 212 documented anomalies in the zoo.¹ The vertical red line shows where the Sharpe ratio for the RTS strategy falls in the distribution. The RTS strategy’s gross (net) Sharpe ratio of 0.37 (0.30) is greater than 78% (91%) of anomaly Sharpe ratios, respectively.

Figure 3 plots the growth of a \$1 invested in these same 212 anomaly trading strategies (gray lines), and compares those with the growth of a \$1 invested in the RTS strategy (red line).² Ignoring trading costs, a \$1 invested in the RTS strategy would have yielded \$4.42 which ranks the RTS strategy in the top 7% across the

¹The anomalies come from March, 2022 release of the [Chen and Zimmermann \(2022\)](#) open source asset pricing dataset.

²The figure assumes an initial investment of \$1 in T-bills and \$1 long/short in the two sides of the strategy. Returns are compounded each month, assuming, as in [Detzel et al. \(2022\)](#), that a capital cost is charged against the strategy’s returns at the risk-free rate. This excess return corresponds more closely to the strategy’s economic profitability.

212 anomalies. Accounting for trading costs, a \$1 invested in the RTS strategy would have yielded \$2.80 which ranks the RTS strategy in the top 6% across the 212 anomalies.

Figure 4 plots percentile ranks for the 212 anomaly trading strategies in terms of gross and Novy-Marx and Velikov (2016) net generalized alphas with respect to the CAPM, and the Fama-French three-, four-, five-, and six-factor models from Table 1, and indicates the ranking of the RTS relative to those. Panel A shows that the RTS strategy gross alphas fall between the 46 and 83 percentiles across the five factor models. Panel B shows that, accounting for trading costs, a large fraction of anomalies have not improved the investment opportunity set of an investor with access to the factor models over the 196306 to 202406 sample. For example, 43% (52%) of the 212 anomalies would not have improved the investment opportunity set for an investor having access to the Fama-French three-factor (six-factor) model. The RTS strategy has a positive net generalized alpha for five out of the five factor models. In these cases RTS ranks between the 59 and 93 percentiles in terms of how much it could have expanded the achievable investment frontier.

6 Does RTS add relative to related anomalies?

With so many anomalies, it is possible that any proposed, new cross-sectional predictor is just capturing some combination of known predictors. It is consequently natural to investigate to what extent the proposed predictor adds additional predictive power beyond the most closely related anomalies. Closely related anomalies are more likely to be formed on the basis of signals with higher absolute correlations. Figure 5 plots a name histogram of the correlations of RTS with 210 filtered anomaly signals.³ Figure 6 also shows an agglomerative hierarchical cluster plot using Ward's

³When performing tests at the underlying signal level (e.g., the correlations plotted in Figure 5), we filter the 212 anomalies to avoid small sample issues. For each anomaly, we calculate the common

minimum method and a maximum of 10 clusters.

A closely related anomaly is also more likely to price RTS or at least to weaken the power RTS has predicting the cross-section of returns. Figure 7 plots histograms of t-statistics for predictability tests of RTS conditioning on each of the 210 filtered anomaly signals one at a time. Panel A reports t-statistics on β_{RTS} from Fama-MacBeth regressions of the form $r_{i,t} = \alpha + \beta_{RTS}RTS_{i,t} + \beta_X X_{i,t} + \epsilon_{i,t}$, where X stands for one of the 210 filtered anomaly signals at a time. Panel B plots t-statistics on α from spanning tests of the form: $r_{RTS,t} = \alpha + \beta r_{X,t} + \epsilon_t$, where $r_{X,t}$ stands for the returns to one of the 210 filtered anomaly trading strategies at a time. The strategies employed in the spanning tests are constructed using quintile sorts, value-weighting, and NYSE breakpoints. Panel C plots t-statistics on the average returns to strategies constructed by conditional double sorts. In each month, we sort stocks into quintiles based one of the 210 filtered anomaly signals. Then, within each quintile, we sort stocks into quintiles based on RTS. Stocks are finally grouped into five RTS portfolios by combining stocks within each anomaly sorting portfolio. The panel plots the t-statistics on the average returns of these conditional double-sorted RTS trading strategies conditioned on each of the 210 filtered anomalies.

Table 4 reports Fama-MacBeth cross-sectional regressions of returns on RTS and the six anomalies most closely-related to it. The six most-closely related anomalies are picked as those with the highest combined rank where the ranks are based on the absolute value of the Spearman correlations in Panel B of Figure 5 and the R^2 from the spanning tests in Figure 7, Panel B. Controlling for each of these signals at a time, the t-statistics on the RTS signal in these Fama-MacBeth regressions exceed -0.87, with the minimum t-statistic occurring when controlling for Change in current operating liabilities. Controlling for all six closely related anomalies, the t-statistic

stock observations in an average month for which both the anomaly and the test signal are available. In the filtered anomaly set, we drop anomalies with fewer than 100 common stock observations in an average month.

on RTS is 0.96.

Similarly, Table 5 reports results from spanning tests that regress returns to the RTS strategy onto the returns of the six most closely-related anomalies and the six Fama-French factors. Controlling for the six most-closely related anomalies individually, the RTS strategy earns alphas that range from 23-35bps/month. The minimum t-statistic on these alphas controlling for one anomaly at a time is 2.84, which is achieved when controlling for Change in current operating liabilities. Controlling for all six closely-related anomalies and the six Fama-French factors simultaneously, the RTS trading strategy achieves an alpha of 22bps/month with a t-statistic of 2.80.

7 Does RTS add relative to the whole zoo?

Finally, we can ask how much adding RTS to the entire factor zoo could improve investment performance. Figure 8 plots the growth of \$1 invested in trading strategies that combine multiple anomalies following [Chen and Velikov \(2022\)](#). The combinations use either the 154 anomalies from the zoo that satisfy our inclusion criteria (blue lines) or these 154 anomalies augmented with the RTS signal.⁴ We consider one different methods for combining signals.

Panel A shows results using “Average rank” as the combination method. This method sorts stocks on the basis of forecast excess returns, where these are calculated on the basis of their average cross-sectional percentile rank across return predictors, and the predictors are all signed so that higher ranks are associated with higher average returns. For this method, \$1 investment in the 154-anomaly combination strategy grows to \$2560.30, while \$1 investment in the combination strategy that includes RTS grows to \$2610.21.

⁴We filter the 207 [Chen and Zimmermann \(2022\)](#) anomalies and require for each anomaly the average month to have at least 40% of the cross-sectional observations available for market capitalization on CRSP in the period for which RTS is available.

8 Conclusion

This study provides compelling evidence that Revenue Tax Sensitivity (RTS) represents a robust and economically significant predictor of cross-sectional stock returns. Our analysis, conducted using the rigorous testing protocol of Novy-Marx and Velikov (2023), demonstrates that RTS-based trading strategies generate substantial risk-adjusted returns that persist even after controlling for established risk factors and closely related anomalies.

The key findings reveal that a value-weighted long/short strategy based on RTS delivers an annualized gross Sharpe ratio of 0.37, which remains economically meaningful at 0.30 after accounting for transaction costs. The strategy’s ability to generate monthly abnormal returns of 36 basis points relative to the Fama-French five-factor model plus momentum, with a highly significant t-statistic of 4.43, underscores its predictive power. Particularly noteworthy is the signal’s resilience when tested against a comprehensive set of controls, maintaining a statistically significant alpha of 22 basis points per month even after adjusting for six established factors and six closely related growth and investment strategies.

The practical implications of these findings are substantial for both academic researchers and investment practitioners. For academics, RTS emerges as a distinct source of cross-sectional return variation that cannot be fully explained by existing factor models or related corporate growth and investment characteristics. For practitioners, the signal’s net-of-cost Sharpe ratio of 0.30 suggests potential implementation value, though careful consideration of market impact and execution costs remains essential for real-world application.

Several limitations of this study warrant acknowledgment and suggest avenues for future research. First, while our analysis controls for numerous established factors, the underlying economic mechanism driving the RTS effect requires further theoretical and empirical investigation. Understanding whether this predictability stems

from risk-based explanations or behavioral biases would enhance our interpretation of the results. Second, the stability and persistence of the RTS signal across different market regimes and international markets remains unexplored. Future research should examine whether the documented return predictability extends beyond U.S. equities and how it performs during various macroeconomic conditions.

Additionally, future studies could investigate the interaction between RTS and firm-specific characteristics such as size, profitability, and financial constraints to better understand the cross-sectional variation in the signal's effectiveness. The relationship between RTS and corporate tax planning strategies also merits deeper exploration, as it may reveal important connections between tax management, firm value, and expected returns. Finally, examining the signal's performance in out-of-sample periods and its robustness to alternative variable constructions would further validate its practical applicability.

In conclusion, this paper establishes Revenue Tax Sensitivity as a significant and robust predictor of equity returns that adds incremental explanatory power beyond existing factor models. While questions remain about its economic foundations and broader applicability, the evidence strongly supports its inclusion in the constellation of return-predictive signals worthy of both academic study and practical consideration.

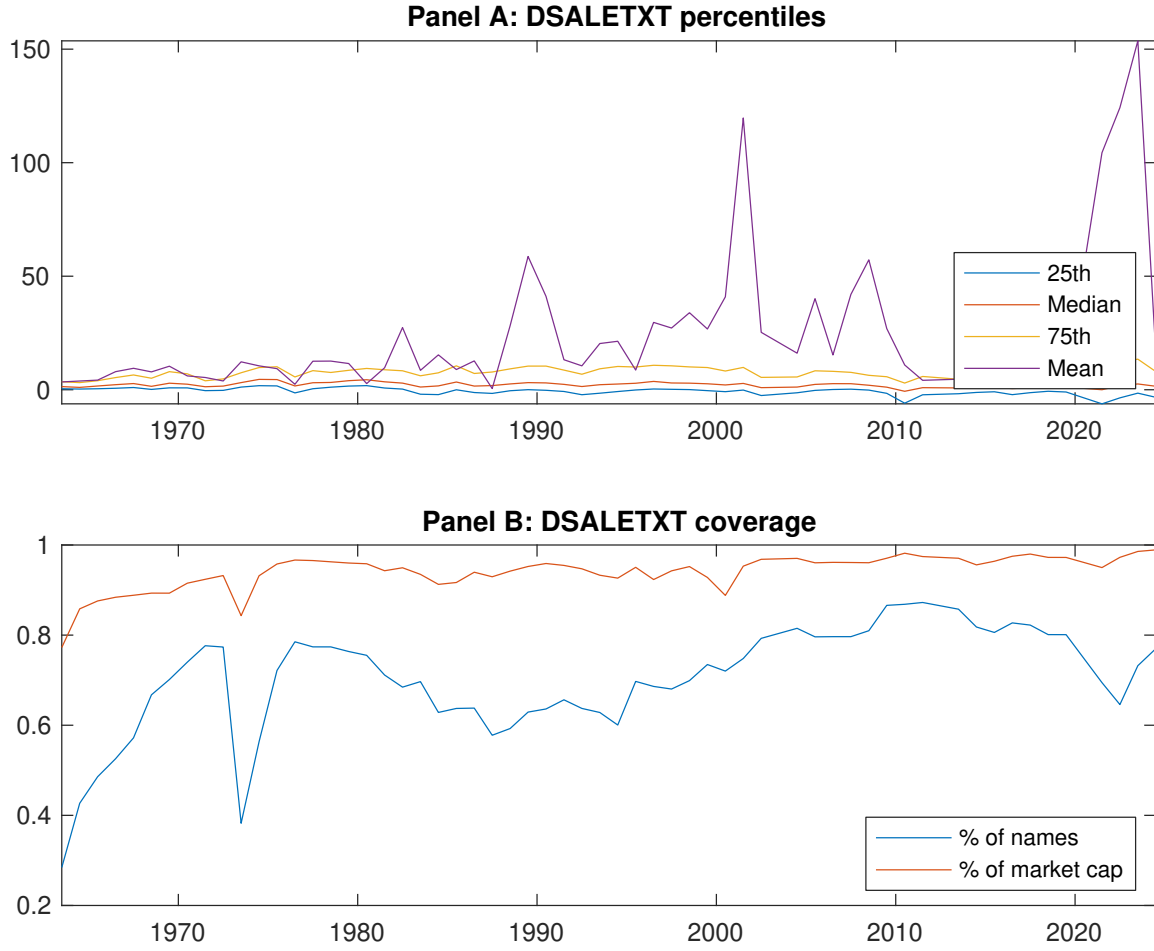


Figure 1: Times series of RTS percentiles and coverage.
This figure plots descriptive statistics for RTS. Panel A shows cross-sectional percentiles of RTS over the sample. Panel B plots the monthly coverage of RTS relative to the universe of CRSP stocks with available market capitalizations.

Table 1: Basic sort: VW, quintile, NYSE-breaks

This table reports average excess returns and alphas for portfolios sorted on RTS. At the end of each month, we sort stocks into five portfolios based on their signal using NYSE breakpoints. Panel A reports average value-weighted quintile portfolio (L,2,3,4,H) returns in excess of the risk-free rate, the long-short extreme quintile portfolio (H-L) return, and alphas with respect to the CAPM, [Fama and French \(1993\)](#) three-factor model, [Fama and French \(1993\)](#) three-factor model augmented with the [Carhart \(1997\)](#) momentum factor, [Fama and French \(2015a\)](#) five-factor model, and the [Fama and French \(2015a\)](#) five-factor model augmented with the [Carhart \(1997\)](#) momentum factor following [Fama and French \(2018\)](#). Panel B reports the factor loadings for the quintile portfolios and long-short extreme quintile portfolio in the [Fama and French \(2015a\)](#) five-factor model. Panel C reports the average number of stocks and market capitalization of each portfolio. T-statistics are in brackets. The sample period is 196306 to 202406.

Panel A: Excess returns and alphas on RTS-sorted portfolios						
	(L)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(H)	(H-L)
r^e	0.47 [2.53]	0.58 [3.84]	0.65 [4.07]	0.63 [3.51]	0.74 [3.68]	0.27 [2.88]
α_{CAPM}	-0.15 [-2.28]	0.07 [1.43]	0.10 [2.46]	0.01 [0.25]	0.06 [0.95]	0.21 [2.19]
α_{FF3}	-0.24 [-4.02]	0.02 [0.53]	0.08 [2.17]	0.03 [0.72]	0.10 [1.80]	0.34 [3.99]
α_{FF4}	-0.18 [-2.97]	0.02 [0.42]	0.07 [1.84]	0.05 [1.10]	0.10 [1.85]	0.28 [3.27]
α_{FF5}	-0.24 [-4.22]	-0.07 [-1.59]	0.04 [1.15]	0.01 [0.25]	0.18 [3.31]	0.42 [5.22]
α_{FF6}	-0.18 [-3.22]	-0.06 [-1.45]	0.04 [0.93]	0.02 [0.57]	0.18 [3.18]	0.36 [4.43]
Panel B: Fama and French (2018) 6-factor model loadings for RTS-sorted portfolios						
β_{MKT}	1.07 [79.64]	0.95 [93.57]	0.97 [102.35]	1.04 [102.49]	1.08 [80.88]	0.01 [0.43]
β_{SMB}	0.07 [3.63]	-0.12 [-8.52]	-0.08 [-5.51]	-0.01 [-0.84]	0.16 [8.24]	0.09 [3.16]
β_{HML}	0.05 [1.98]	0.06 [3.26]	0.08 [4.29]	0.02 [0.96]	-0.04 [-1.47]	-0.09 [-2.39]
β_{RMW}	-0.16 [-6.10]	0.13 [6.39]	0.11 [6.18]	0.16 [8.15]	-0.08 [-3.13]	0.08 [2.09]
β_{CMA}	0.34 [9.01]	0.23 [8.15]	-0.01 [-0.49]	-0.17 [-5.94]	-0.28 [-7.29]	-0.62 [-11.30]
β_{UMD}	-0.08 [-6.30]	-0.01 [-0.71]	0.01 [1.19]	-0.02 [-1.98]	0.01 [0.50]	0.09 [4.73]
Panel C: Average number of firms (n) and market capitalization (me)						
n	713	536	532	582	772	
me (\$10 ⁶)	1079	2317	2817	2300	1564	

Table 2: Robustness to sorting methodology & trading costs

This table evaluates the robustness of the choices made in the RTS strategy construction methodology. In each panel, the first row shows results from a quintile, value-weighted sort using NYSE break points as employed in Table 1. Each of the subsequent rows deviates in one of the three choices at a time, and the choices are specified in the first three columns. For each strategy construction methodology, the table reports average excess returns and alphas with respect to the CAPM, Fama and French (1993) three-factor model, Fama and French (1993) three-factor model augmented with the Carhart (1997) momentum factor, Fama and French (2015a) five-factor model, and the Fama and French (2015a) five-factor model augmented with the Carhart (1997) momentum factor following Fama and French (2018). Panel A reports average returns and alphas with no adjustment for trading costs. Panel B reports net average returns and Novy-Marx and Velikov (2016) generalized alphas as prescribed by Detzel et al. (2022). T-statistics are in brackets. The sample period is 196306 to 202406.

Panel A: Gross Returns and Alphas								
Portfolios	Breaks	Weights	r^e	α_{CAPM}	α_{FF3}	α_{FF4}	α_{FF5}	α_{FF6}
Quintile	NYSE	VW	0.27 [2.88]	0.21 [2.19]	0.34 [3.99]	0.28 [3.27]	0.42 [5.22]	0.36 [4.43]
Quintile	NYSE	EW	-0.13 [-2.41]	-0.17 [-3.31]	-0.11 [-2.35]	-0.11 [-2.14]	-0.12 [-2.74]	-0.12 [-2.63]
Quintile	Name	VW	0.30 [3.05]	0.24 [2.42]	0.38 [4.21]	0.34 [3.76]	0.45 [5.29]	0.41 [4.75]
Quintile	Cap	VW	0.14 [1.48]	0.05 [0.51]	0.19 [2.40]	0.18 [2.28]	0.29 [4.06]	0.27 [3.74]
Decile	NYSE	VW	0.25 [2.31]	0.20 [1.87]	0.33 [3.31]	0.30 [2.94]	0.41 [4.06]	0.37 [3.64]
Panel B: Net Returns and Novy-Marx and Velikov (2016) generalized alphas								
Portfolios	Breaks	Weights	r_{net}^e	α_{CAPM}^*	α_{FF3}^*	α_{FF4}^*	α_{FF5}^*	α_{FF6}^*
Quintile	NYSE	VW	0.23 [2.37]	0.15 [1.57]	0.27 [3.13]	0.24 [2.76]	0.31 [3.84]	0.28 [3.47]
Quintile	NYSE	EW	-0.35 [-5.57]					
Quintile	Name	VW	0.25 [2.50]	0.17 [1.70]	0.29 [3.25]	0.27 [3.04]	0.33 [3.83]	0.31 [3.59]
Quintile	Cap	VW	0.10 [1.05]		0.12 [1.56]	0.12 [1.55]	0.19 [2.57]	0.18 [2.46]
Decile	NYSE	VW	0.18 [1.69]	0.13 [1.23]	0.25 [2.47]	0.23 [2.29]	0.29 [2.89]	0.27 [2.69]

Table 3: Conditional sort on size and RTS

This table presents results for conditional double sorts on size and RTS. In each month, stocks are first sorted into quintiles based on size using NYSE breakpoints. Then, within each size quintile, stocks are further sorted based on RTS. Finally, they are grouped into twenty-five portfolios based on the intersection of the two sorts. Panel A presents the average returns to the 25 portfolios, as well as strategies that go long stocks with high RTS and short stocks with low RTS .Panel B documents the average number of firms and the average firm size for each portfolio. The sample period is 196306 to 202406.

Panel A: portfolio average returns and time-series regression results												
Size quintiles	RTS Quintiles					RTS Strategies						
		(L)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(H)	r^e	α_{CAPM}	α_{FF3}	α_{FF4}	α_{FF5}	α_{FF6}
	(1)	0.97 [3.45]	0.92 [4.30]	0.91 [4.33]	0.85 [3.72]	0.63 [2.44]	-0.34 [-2.96]	-0.35 [-3.04]	-0.28 [-2.49]	-0.24 [-2.05]	-0.25 [-2.20]	-0.22 [-1.89]
	(2)	0.85 [3.68]	0.78 [3.93]	0.88 [4.28]	0.86 [3.85]	0.80 [3.24]	-0.05 [-0.57]	-0.11 [-1.31]	-0.03 [-0.39]	-0.04 [-0.44]	-0.07 [-0.84]	-0.07 [-0.89]
	(3)	0.71 [3.45]	0.74 [4.14]	0.81 [4.22]	0.86 [4.07]	0.76 [3.26]	0.05 [0.51]	-0.03 [-0.31]	0.07 [0.79]	0.04 [0.43]	0.11 [1.32]	0.08 [0.92]
	(4)	0.63 [3.16]	0.70 [4.23]	0.83 [4.65]	0.72 [3.71]	0.76 [3.47]	0.13 [1.36]	0.06 [0.66]	0.15 [1.71]	0.09 [1.00]	0.21 [2.37]	0.15 [1.67]
	(5)	0.41 [2.50]	0.55 [3.64]	0.61 [3.87]	0.57 [3.26]	0.66 [3.45]	0.25 [2.24]	0.15 [1.39]	0.30 [3.02]	0.29 [2.85]	0.41 [4.27]	0.38 [3.95]
Panel B: Portfolio average number of firms and market capitalization												
Size quintiles	RTS Quintiles					RTS Quintiles						
		Average n					Average market capitalization (\$10 ⁶)					
		(L)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(H)	(L)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(H)	
	(1)	316	321	322	321	319	23	27	31	31	27	
	(2)	102	102	102	102	102	51	53	53	53	52	
	(3)	77	77	77	77	77	94	95	97	97	95	
	(4)	66	67	66	66	66	206	212	209	209	206	
(5)	62	62	62	62	62	1375	1779	1799	1716	1485		

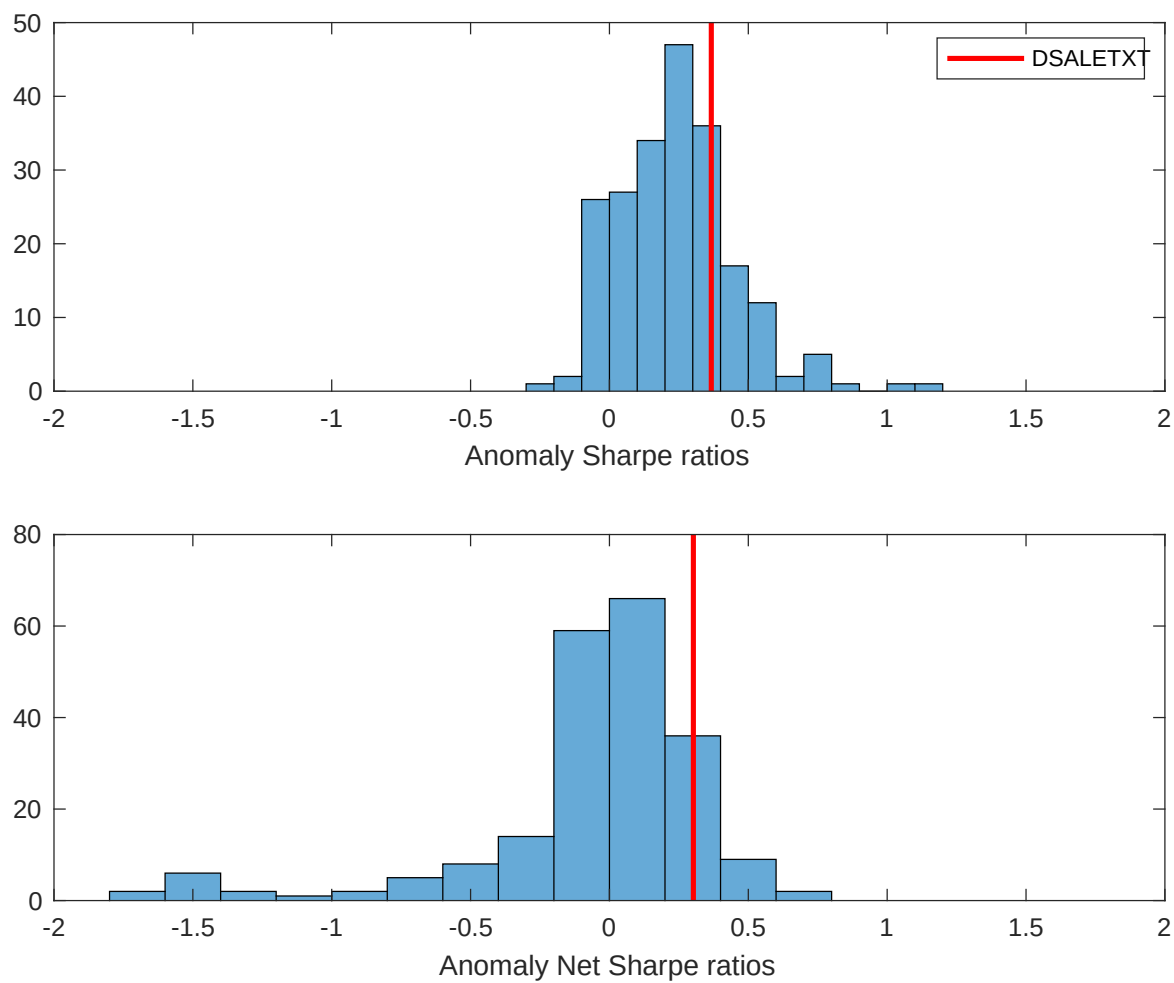


Figure 2: Distribution of Sharpe ratios.

This figure plots a histogram of Sharpe ratios for 212 anomalies, and compares the Sharpe ratio of the RTS with them (red vertical line). Panel A plots results for gross Sharpe ratios. Panel B plots results for net Sharpe ratios.

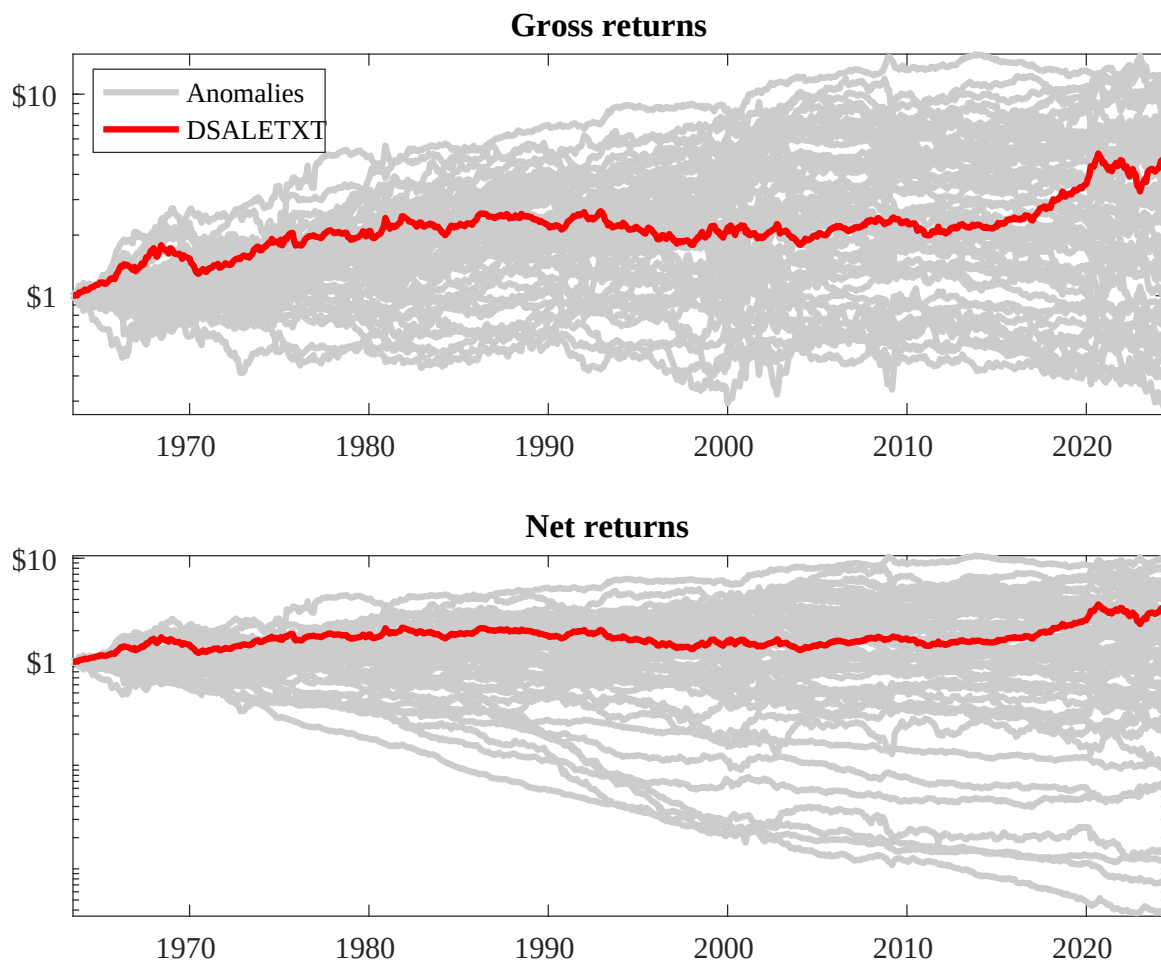
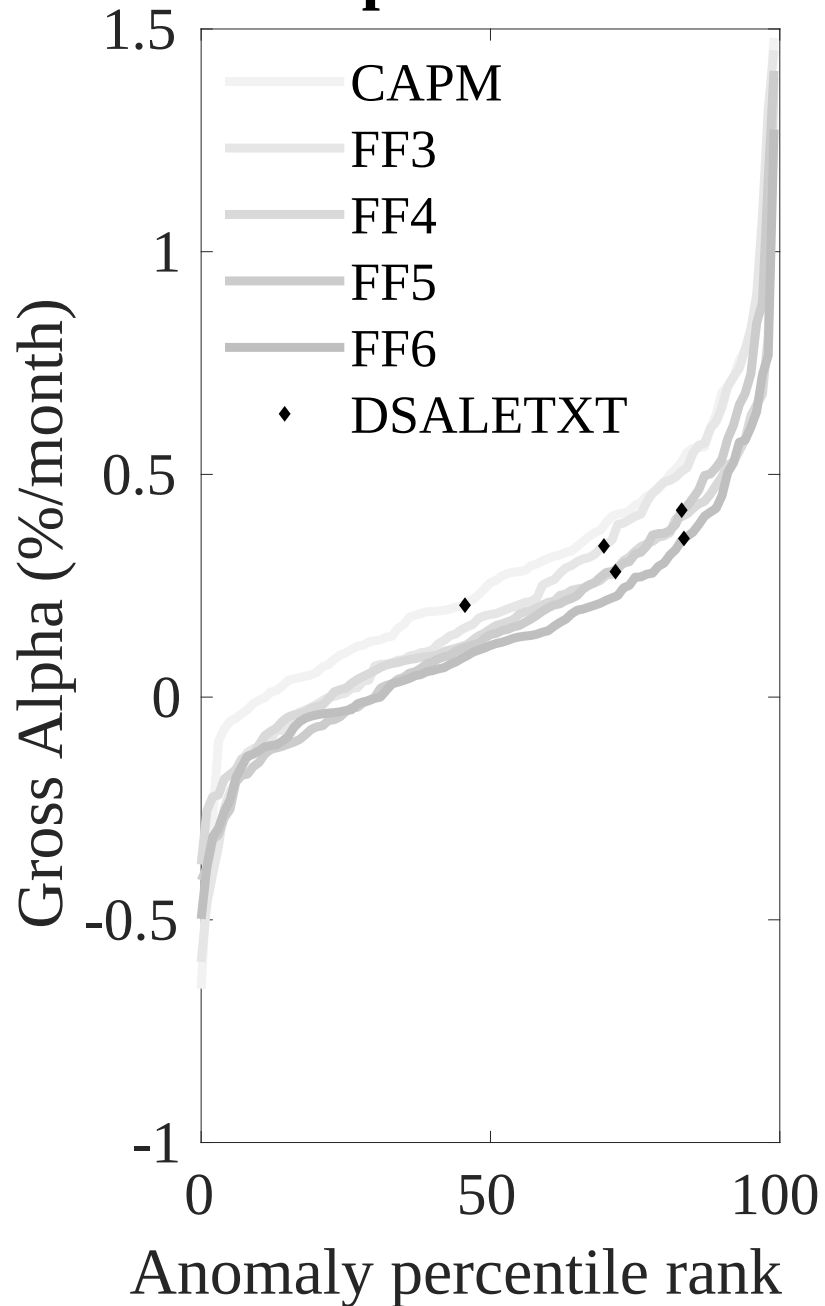


Figure 3: Dollar invested.

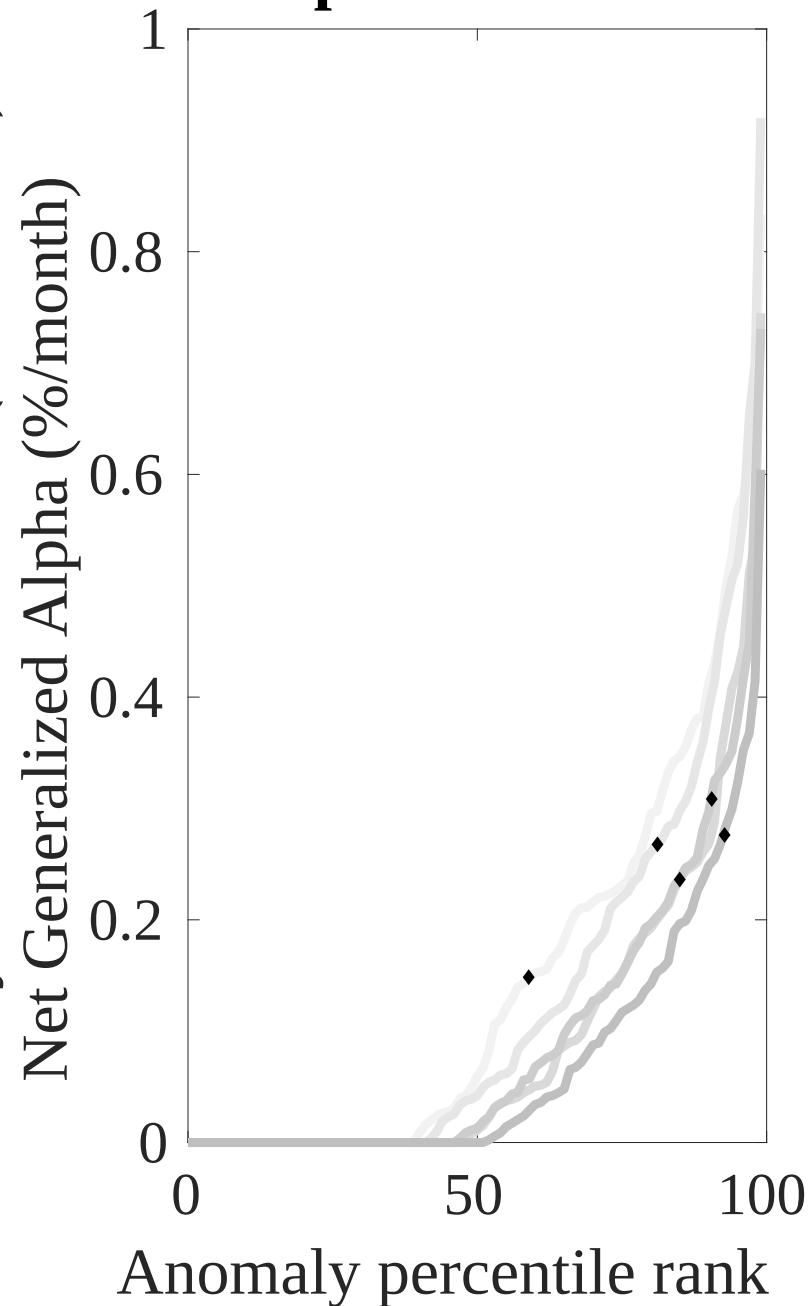
This figure plots the growth of a \$1 invested in 212 anomaly trading strategies (gray lines), and compares those with the RTS trading strategy (red line). The strategies are constructed using value-weighted quintile sorts using NYSE breakpoints. Panel A plots results for gross strategy returns. Panel B plots results for net strategy returns.

Gross Alpha Percentiles



Novy-Marx and Velikov (RFS, 2016)

Net Alpha Percentiles



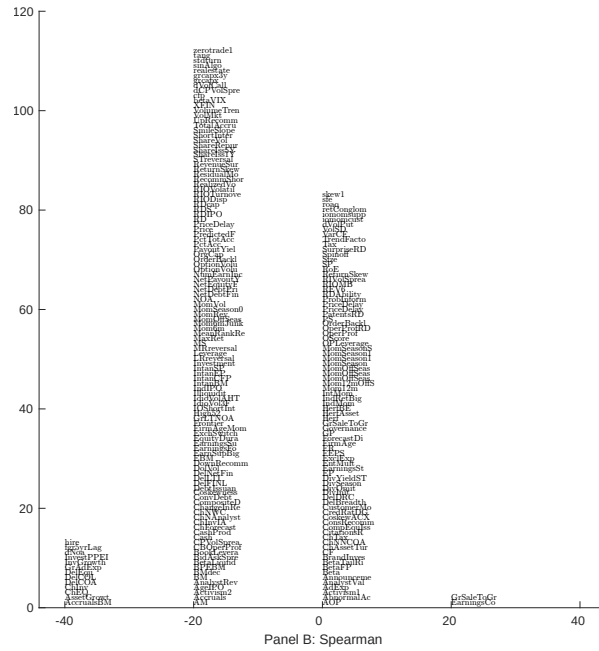
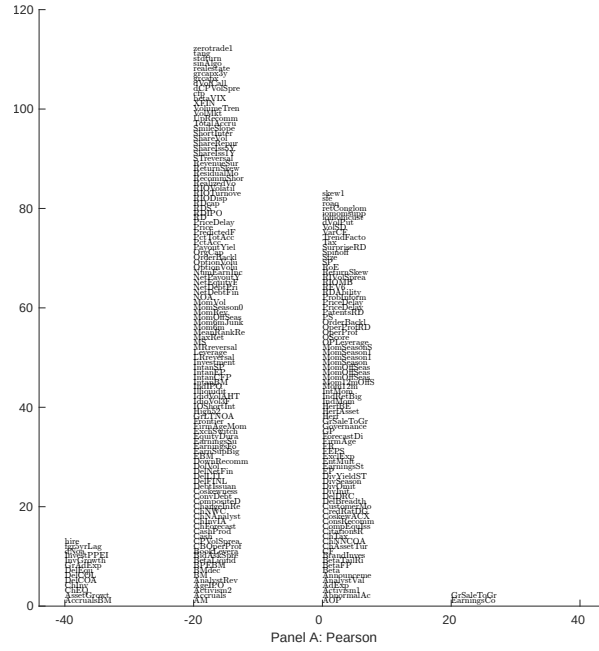


Figure 5: Distribution of correlations.

This figure plots a name histogram of correlations of 210 filtered anomaly signals with RTS. The correlations are pooled. Panel A plots Pearson correlations, while Panel B plots Spearman rank correlations.

This figure plots an agglomerative hierarchical cluster plot using Ward's minimum method and a maximum of 10 clusters.

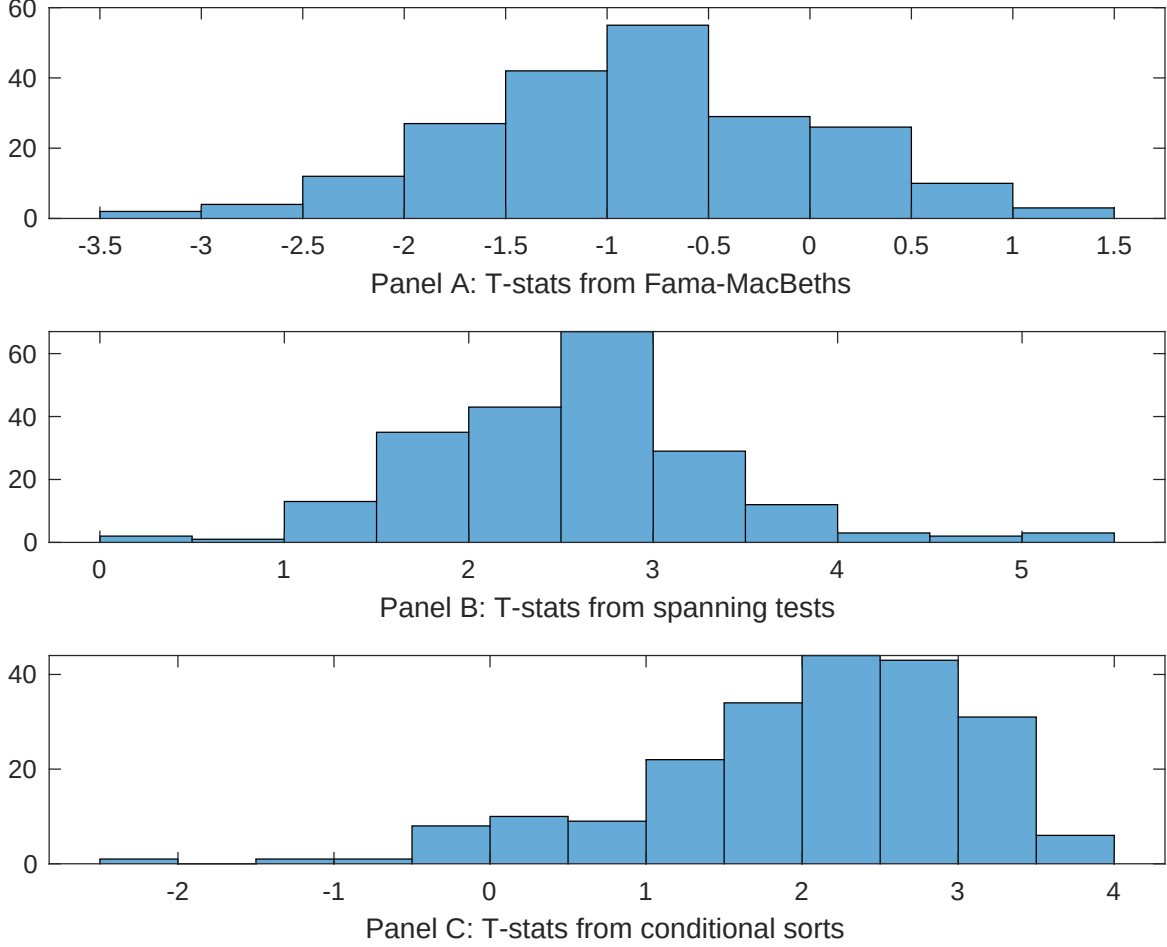


Figure 7: Distribution of t-stats on conditioning strategies

This figure plots histograms of t-statistics for predictability tests of RTS conditioning on each of the 210 filtered anomaly signals one at a time. Panel A reports t-statistics on β_{RTS} from Fama-MacBeth regressions of the form $r_{i,t} = \alpha + \beta_{RTS}RTS_{i,t} + \beta_X X_{i,t} + \epsilon_{i,t}$, where X stands for one of the 210 filtered anomaly signals at a time. Panel B plots t-statistics on α from spanning tests of the form: $r_{RTS,t} = \alpha + \beta r_{X,t} + \epsilon_t$, where $r_{X,t}$ stands for the returns to one of the 210 filtered anomaly trading strategies at a time. The strategies employed in the spanning tests are constructed using quintile sorts, value-weighting, and NYSE breakpoints. Panel C plots t-statistics on the average returns to strategies constructed by conditional double sorts. In each month, we sort stocks into quintiles based one of the 210 filtered anomaly signals at a time. Then, within each quintile, we sort stocks into quintiles based on RTS. Stocks are finally grouped into five RTS portfolios by combining stocks within each anomaly sorting portfolio. The panel plots the t-statistics on the average returns of these conditional double-sorted RTS trading strategies conditioned on each of the 210 filtered anomalies.

Table 4: Fama-MacBeths controlling for most closely related anomalies

This table presents Fama-MacBeth results of returns on RTS. and the six most closely related anomalies. The regressions take the following form: $r_{i,t} = \alpha + \beta_{RTS}RTS_{i,t} + \sum_{k=1}^s \beta_{X_k} X_{i,t}^k + \epsilon_{i,t}$. The six most closely related anomalies, X , are Asset growth, Employment growth, Change in current operating assets, change in ppe and inv/assets, Growth in book equity, Change in current operating liabilities. These anomalies were picked as those with the highest combined rank where the ranks are based on the absolute value of the Spearman correlations in Panel B of Figure 5 and the R^2 from the spanning tests in Figure 7, Panel B. The sample period is 196306 to 202406.

Intercept	0.13 [6.55]	0.12 [5.86]	0.13 [6.14]	0.14 [6.42]	0.17 [7.13]	0.12 [6.03]	0.13 [5.30]
RTS	0.34 [0.72]	-0.39 [-0.73]	0.21 [0.04]	0.36 [0.67]	-0.14 [-0.22]	-0.44 [-0.87]	0.57 [0.96]
Anomaly 1	0.97 [8.67]						0.54 [4.69]
Anomaly 2		0.83 [6.04]					0.30 [0.24]
Anomaly 3			0.18 [5.88]				0.57 [1.71]
Anomaly 4				0.15 [8.25]			0.66 [2.75]
Anomaly 5					0.42 [3.63]		-0.32 [-0.32]
Anomaly 6						0.14 [3.63]	-0.84 [-2.10]
# months	732	713	732	732	720	732	713
$\bar{R}^2(\%)$	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Table 5: Spanning tests controlling for most closely related anomalies

This table presents spanning tests results of regressing returns to the RTS trading strategy on trading strategies exploiting the six most closely related anomalies. The regressions take the following form: $r_t^{RTS} = \alpha + \sum_{k=1}^6 \beta_{X_k} r_t^{X_k} + \sum_{j=1}^6 \beta_{f_j} r_t^{f_j} + \epsilon_t$, where X_k indicates each of the six most-closely related anomalies and f_j indicates the six factors from the [Fama and French \(2015a\)](#) five-factor model augmented with the [Carhart \(1997\)](#) momentum factor. The six most closely related anomalies, X , are Asset growth, Employment growth, Change in current operating assets, change in ppe and inv/assets, Growth in book equity, Change in current operating liabilities. These anomalies were picked as those with the highest combined rank where the ranks are based on the absolute value of the Spearman correlations in Panel B of Figure 5 and the R^2 from the spanning tests in Figure 7, Panel B. The sample period is 196306 to 202406.

Intercept	0.34 [4.31]	0.23 [2.84]	0.34 [4.27]	0.34 [4.36]	0.35 [4.36]	0.28 [3.48]	0.22 [2.80]
Anomaly 1	-24.35 [-5.13]						-12.40 [-2.20]
Anomaly 2		-34.37 [-7.98]					-23.70 [-5.13]
Anomaly 3			-19.11 [-4.89]				-2.04 [-0.45]
Anomaly 4				-25.46 [-6.94]			-16.19 [-4.14]
Anomaly 5					-4.88 [-1.11]		7.79 [1.63]
Anomaly 6						-21.96 [-5.85]	-8.39 [-1.84]
mkt	0.70 [0.37]	-0.14 [-0.07]	0.85 [0.45]	1.04 [0.55]	0.56 [0.29]	1.52 [0.80]	0.83 [0.45]
smb	10.89 [3.93]	7.49 [2.76]	4.95 [1.72]	9.96 [3.67]	9.10 [3.25]	8.29 [3.03]	8.68 [3.05]
hml	-8.17 [-2.22]	-3.24 [-0.87]	-1.83 [-0.46]	-6.22 [-1.71]	-8.44 [-2.24]	-0.55 [-0.14]	0.24 [0.06]
rmw	8.55 [2.31]	7.51 [2.05]	5.97 [1.60]	8.35 [2.28]	7.97 [2.11]	9.95 [2.69]	8.81 [2.41]
cma	-32.21 [-4.09]	-31.32 [-4.78]	-51.12 [-8.79]	-42.06 [-6.98]	-56.87 [-8.18]	-49.30 [-8.55]	-15.20 [-1.84]
umd	8.13 [4.30]	10.60 [5.66]	8.07 [4.25]	8.92 [4.80]	8.95 [4.66]	7.46 [3.94]	8.95 [4.80]
# months	732	713	732	732	732	732	713
$\bar{R}^2(\%)$	39	42	39	41	37	39	45

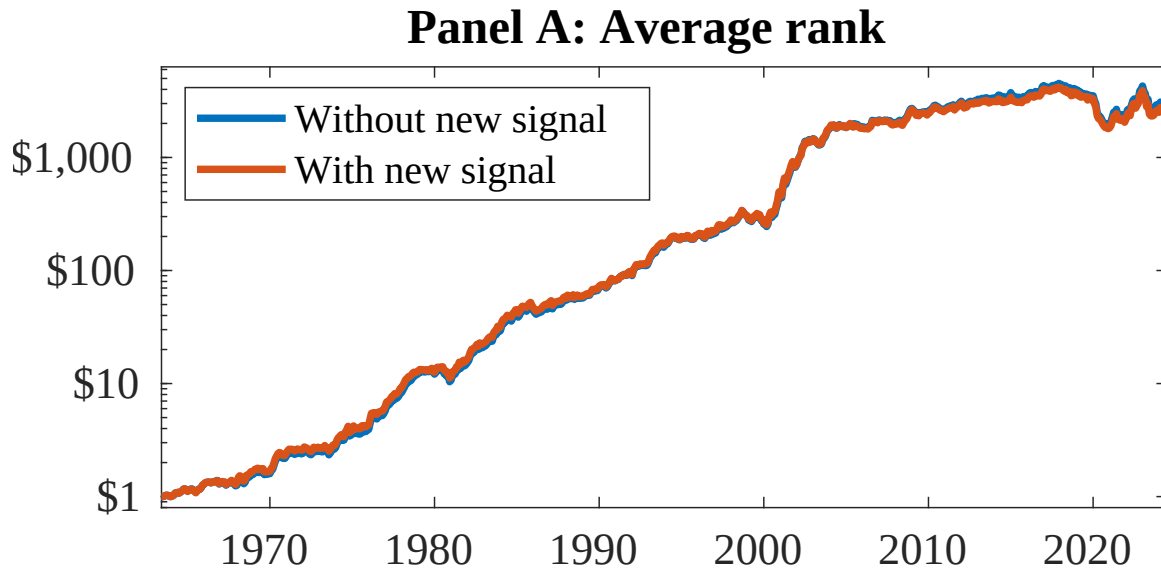


Figure 8: Combination strategy performance

This figure plots the growth of a \$1 invested in trading strategies that combine multiple anomalies following [Chen and Velikov \(2022\)](#). In all panels, the blue solid lines indicate combination trading strategies that utilize 154 anomalies. The red solid lines indicate combination trading strategies that utilize the 154 anomalies as well as RTS. Panel A shows results using "Average rank" as the combination method. See Section 7 for details on the combination methods.

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